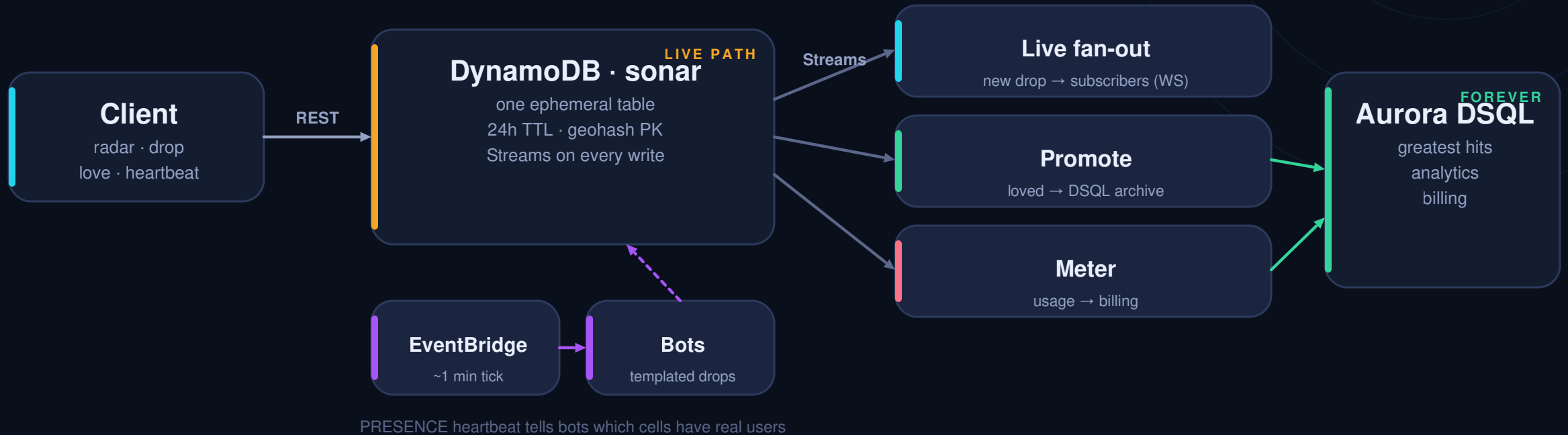


How Sonar's data layer works



One ephemeral table keeps the live radar fast; Streams turn the crowd's love into permanence.

What's near me

1 query × 9 cells

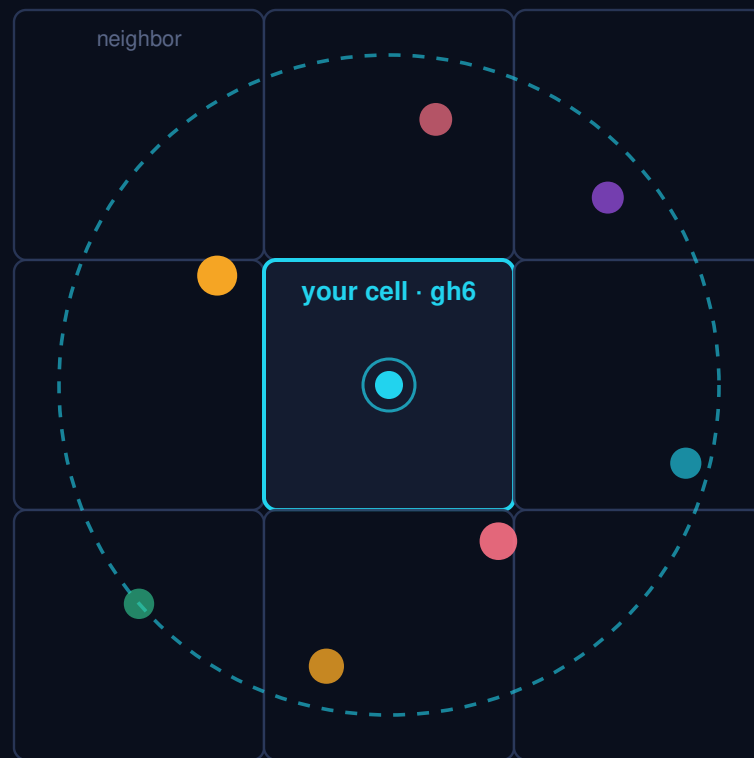
your cell + 8 neighbors, per channel

merge & rank

proximity + freshness, client-side

exact distance

haversine in the browser → color

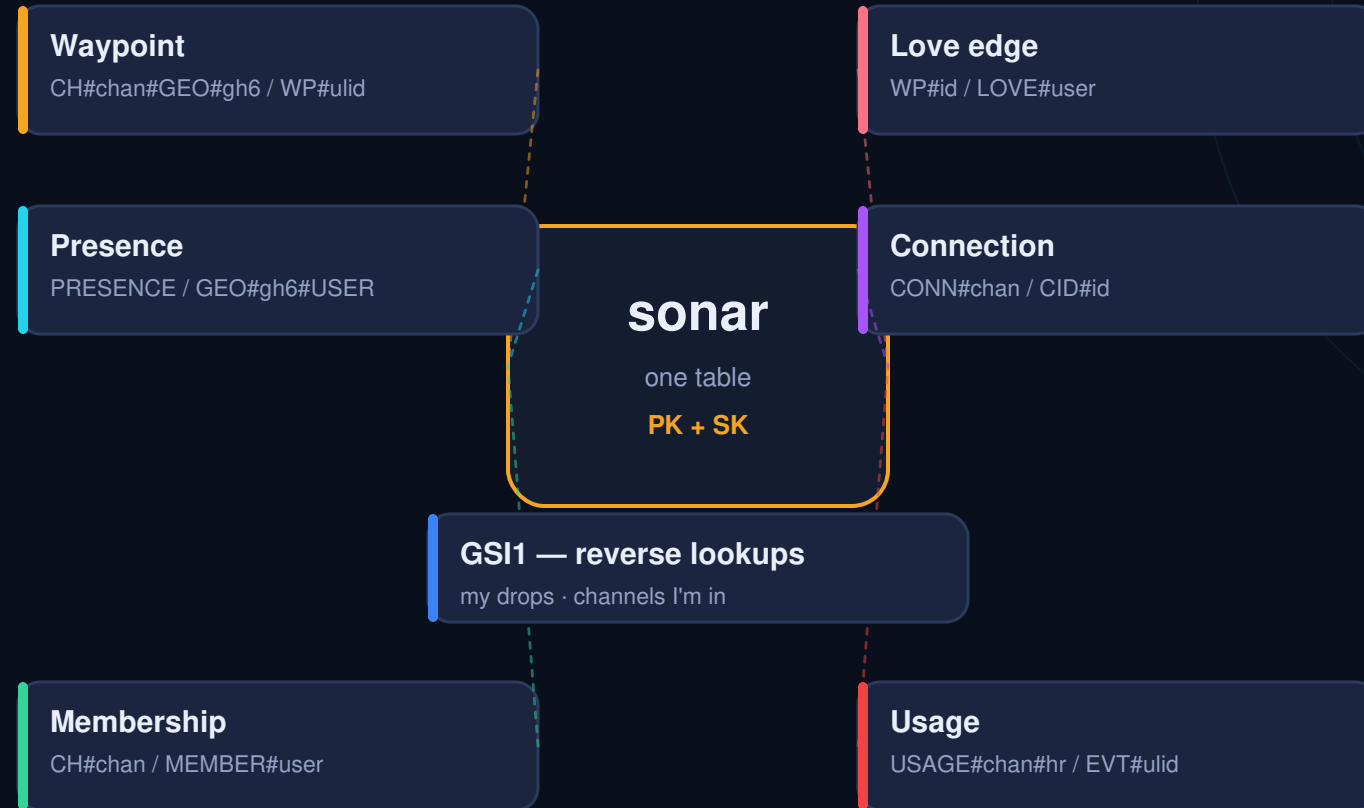


COLOR = DISTANCE



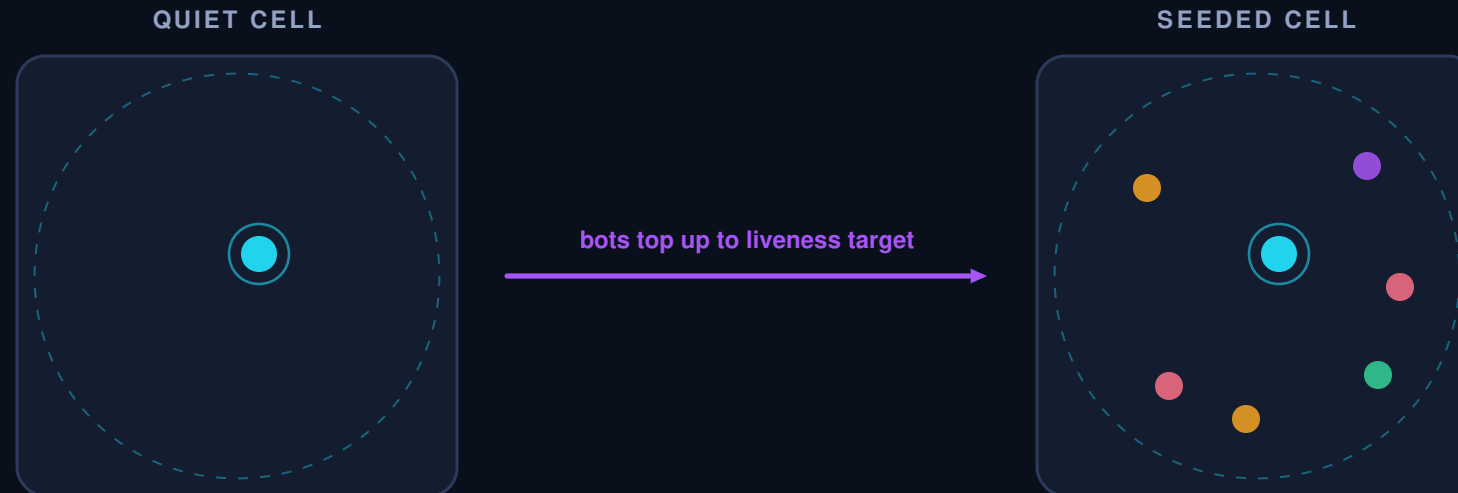
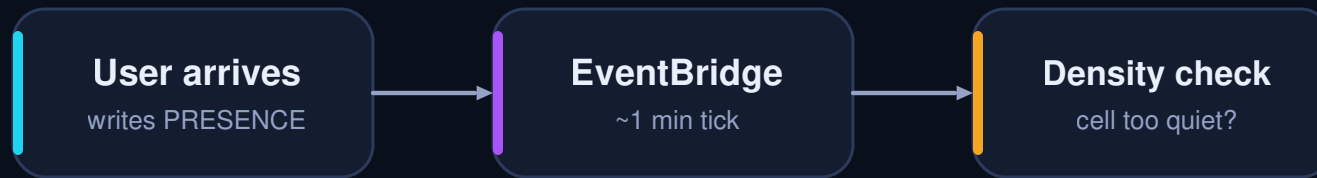
The world is a grid of geohash cells. Query your cell plus its 8 neighbors, then color each drop by real distance.

One table, many shapes



DynamoDB holds six item types under one key schema — the key prefix IS the type. Access patterns drive the design, not entities.

Bots seed the place reactively



tagged actorType=bot

24h TTL cleans them up · never billed, never promoted

No pre-seeded world. When a real user shows up to a quiet cell, bots fill it so the radar is never empty.

Love turns ephemeral into forever

EPHEMERAL DROP

"birria truck, gate C —
line is short rn"



24h TTL
auto-expires



everything else fades at 24h

REALLOVE (human only)

40



bot love never counts toward the threshold

Streams: $\text{realLove} \geq 40$



GREATEST HITS · DSQL

"birria truck, gate C"

 promoted — kept forever

browsable at this spot
and on home

Every drop expires in 24h — unless the crowd loves it past the threshold. Then a Stream copies it to the permanent archive.